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Graduate Recruitment Team

Engelhart Commodities Trading Partners

London

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Commodity Trading Analytics Internship Program in London, with a particular interest in energy and agricultural commodities. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Engelhart's agreement to acquire the energy trader Trailstone, adding to a commodity trading business of around 180 professionals, makes it one of the most interesting energy trading firms in London to join now.

Much of my work centres on commodity markets. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, tests whether governments that hedge oil change how their currencies react to OPEC news: whether Norway's krone conversions, Russia's 2017–22 budget rule and Mexico's put hedge make the oil beta smaller, kinked or one-sided, and whether any beta that remains can be traded after costs. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I built a wheat calendar-spread strategy in R from futures curve structure and CFTC Commitments of Traders positioning, and published weekly research notes for members.

Sales and trading appeals to me because it joins analysis to a live price and to a client who needs a clear answer quickly. Writing those weekly notes taught me to turn analysis into a view that non-specialists can act on. In nearly two years at KONG, I learned that a recommendation lands only when it fits the person hearing it: by analysing sales patterns and refining our upselling prompts, I raised average customer spend by an estimated 25%. I also take risk seriously: at the Strathclyde Poker Society, where I was Vice-President and then President, I taught new members to use the Kelly criterion to work out how many buy-ins their own win rate, variance and appetite for risk call for.

Engelhart stands out to me because its analytics internship places interns with London front-office teams where commodity markets, data and trading meet, across energy, agriculture, metals and freight. My work sits at that intersection, a dissertation built on OPEC announcement-day oil data and a wheat spread strategy in R, and a six-month placement starting in June 2027 would let me move straight from graduation into that work.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan